



Red Gear Shadow Blade



Corsair K100 RGB

The Red Gear Shadow Blade is a great budget mechanical keyboard option, which comes with many premium features for its low price point.

The Corsair K100 would also be the best option if you're looking for an optical-mechanical keyboard, which offers even more durability and accuracy than a mechanical keyboard. Of course, it's a lot more pricey.

It gets easy once you're past deciding the switch you want. All you need to lookout for then is the keyboard layout, i.e., standard, TKL, mini etc. You need to check whether the keyboard you want or need should have N-key rollover; anti-ghosting is something that's essential on gaming keyboards. This essentially means the keyboard can register multiple keystroke presses at once. Then you want to check for backlighting, which is important if you type in dark environments. Backlighting is not the same as RGB, which is far less important if you're on a budget.

MICE

Much like keyboards, you have plenty of options when it comes to mice, ranging from the low-end to the high-end. While the mouse sensor can be tested objectively, there are some subjective factors that should be considered first. The most important being the use-case.

As a casual gamer, and general user, you can go with just about any mouse. In this situation, you really don't need to worry about the mouse sensor. You can instead choose to

focus on comfort. Comfort is essential regardless of your use case with a mouse, so, even if you're going for a high-end mouse, look for options that you find comfortable. This is a device you will most likely be using for long periods of time, and a mouse being uncomfortable can even pose significant health risks for your wrists.

Things to consider when looking for a mouse when it comes to comfort is the shape of the mouse, whether it's ambidextrous or ergonomic, and the weight. Left-handed mouse users should obviously go for ambidextrous mice. Right-handed users have a lot more options, coming down to the kind of grip they prefer, such as a claw grip, a fingertip grip, or palm grip among others. These terms are more familiar to gamers, and casual mouse users needn't worry about that.

That about does it for general purpose mouse usage, gamers and power users on the other hand have



Razer Naga Trinity

a lot more to consider when picking a mouse. This includes the genre of games they play, or the specific use case. For instance, MMORPG mice come with a plethora of buttons on the side of the mouse. The Razer Naga Trinity for instance, is a great MMORPG and MOBA mouse, but can also double as a great mouse for someone using software with plenty of shortcuts. These can simply be mapped to the extra buttons on the side of the mouse.

FPS gamers would want to go for mice with great sensors, and usually want lighter options, which allow you to freely glide on the

surface with the least resistance. The Logitech G305 Lightspeed gaming mouse is great for FPS gamers. It comes with the excellent HERO sensor, but it's also wireless, meaning no wire drag resistance. It has excellent battery life as well. Being a wireless mouse, it's also a great option for people who work with large displays

Logitech G502
LIGHTSPEEDDragonwar
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and sit further away from their systems. Or, you know, for people who like gaming on their couch.

Most gaming mice come with a polling rate of 1000Hz, which is more than enough as far as tracking speed is concerned. It's the same with extremely high DPI or CPI, you won't really ever need a DPI of 16,000 or 25,000 which some brands advertise. Ensure the mouse you want runs well on the DPI you're most comfortable with. For us, it's between 1600 and 3200.

Much like keyboards, RGB is never essential, and if all it does is increase the cost of the mouse, it's not worth it. Cheaper mice will always come with worse sensors, but for as little as ₹1,500, you can get your hands on a Razer Death Adder Essential, which has the worst sensor Razer has to offer, but it's pretty decent for its price. You will get mice for much cheaper, from the likes of

Dragonwar and Red Dragon which can also potentially serve you well. At ₹4000 however, you can get your hands on the excellent Logitech G502 Hero, which is quite comfortable, has adjustable weight, plenty of buttons, and has a wireless variant which costs quite a bit more. **d**

Logitech G305
LIGHTSPEED